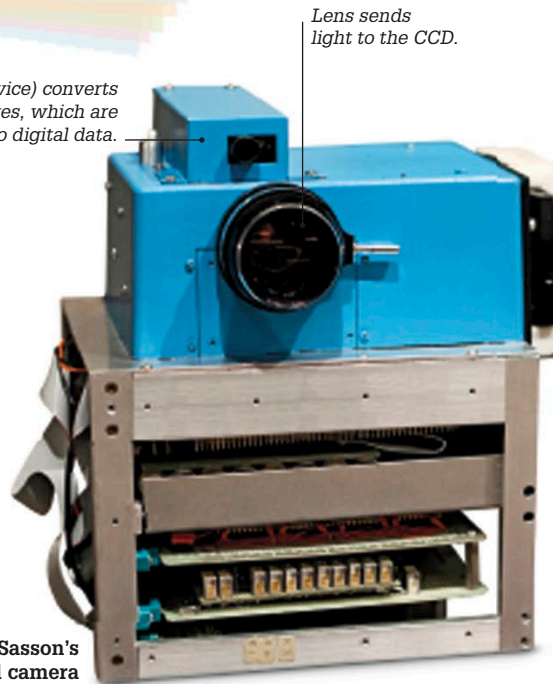


1975 ▶ 1980

1975

First digital camera

American engineer Steve Sasson invented the first digital camera while working at Kodak. Powered by 16 rechargeable batteries, this 7.9 lb (3.6 kg) camera produced grainy black-and-white images with a resolution of 100×100 pixels. It took 23 seconds to shoot one image, which was then stored on a digital cassette tape. Digital cameras store images as digital data in memory rather than physically on film.



Steve Sasson's digital camera

CCD (charge-coupled device) converts light into electric charges, which are then turned into digital data.

Lens sends light to the CCD.

1977

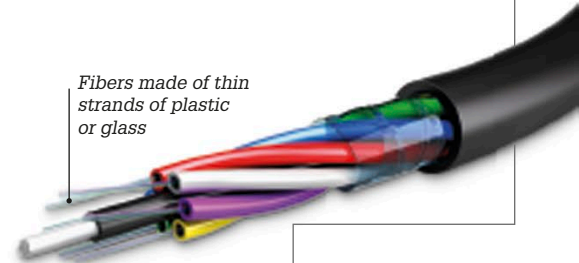
First MRI scan

The first full-body Magnetic Resonance Imaging (MRI) scan was carried out on a human patient by American physician Raymond Vahan Damadian. MRI uses powerful magnetic fields and radio waves to produce detailed pictures of the inside of the human body.

1977

Fiber-optic phone calls

The first live telephone calls sent along optical fibers were transmitted by General Telephone and Electronics Corporation in California. Signals travel as light down the optical fibers, which can carry more information and over longer distances than copper wires and without loss of quality.



Fibers made of thin strands of plastic or glass



1975

This supercomputer consumed 110 kilowatts of power (as much as used at the time by 8–10 homes).



Cray 1 supercomputer

Supercomputers

The first supercomputer, Cray 1, was designed by American engineer Seymour Cray and sold to Los Alamos National Laboratory, in 1976. This high-performance machine was the world's fastest computer until 1982. Supercomputers are used for complicated data-heavy tasks, such as weather forecasting and code-breaking.

1976

1976

Landing on Mars

NASA's Viking 1 and Viking 2 spacecraft became the first space probes to successfully land on Mars and investigate its surface. The two landers were each equipped with cameras and a robotic arm to take samples of the planet's soil.

Apple 1

The first Apple computer was hand-built by American inventor Steve Wozniak and went on sale in 1976 for \$666.66. Users needed their own case, keyboard, power supply, and video display to enjoy a fully working home computer.



Hydrothermal vents were discovered in the Pacific Ocean in 1977. These cracks in the seabed allow hot magma from below to superheat seawater to temperatures as high as 842°F (450°C).

Padded, circular seat concealed large power supply.